

D580

Healthcare Administration Capstone

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A 120-bed rural hospital that has served its county since 1962 is planning an outpatient orthopedic clinic. The planning team learns that a large retirement community is being built ten miles away. The board chair is a retired surgeon. In a SWOT analysis, the new retirement community is a(n):

- A. Not part of SWOT, because the hospital does not control it.
- B. Strength
- C. Opportunity
- D. Threat

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which item belongs in the Weaknesses quadrant of a hospital's SWOT?

- A. The state is expected to cut Medicaid rates.
- B. The hospital has a highly rated cardiac team.
- C. A competing urgent-care chain is opening nearby.
- D. The hospital's own billing office has a 40-day backlog.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A nurse manager on a 28-bed medical unit wants to reduce patient falls. The unit was repainted last spring. She plans an hourly-rounding protocol, predicts falls will drop, and tries it on one hallway for two weeks. What is the next step in the PDSA cycle?

- A. Start over by planning a different protocol.
- B. Study the results and compare them with the prediction.
- C. Roll the protocol out to the whole hospital.
- D. Act by adopting it permanently on the unit.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A billing specialist at a 200-physician practice with offices in two states must fix a claim denied for a wrong procedure code. The practice recently moved to a cloud-based electronic health record. Under HIPAA, what access is appropriate?

- A. Only the information needed to correct and resubmit that claim.
- B. The patient's full medical record, because she is an employee.
- C. No access until the patient signs a written authorization.
- D. No access until the cloud vendor approves the request.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A clinic plans a sleep-study service at \$600 per study. Variable cost is \$250 per study and fixed costs are \$210,000 a year. A consultant noted that about 30% of adults snore. The clinic has three exam rooms. How many studies a year are needed to break even?

- A. 840
- B. 180
- C. 600
- D. 350

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A service breaks even at 500 procedures a year. The price is \$400 and the variable cost is \$160 per procedure. What are the annual fixed costs?

- A. \$280,000
- B. \$120,000
- C. \$80,000
- D. \$200,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A health system spends \$900,000 on a new imaging scanner expected to bring in net cash inflows of \$300,000 a year for five years. The vendor is based in Minnesota and was ranked first by a trade magazine. What is the payback period?

- A. 5 years
- B. \$600,000
- C. 3 years
- D. 0.33 years

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A project with a six-year useful life pays back in 4 years with equal annual inflows of \$125,000. What was the initial investment?

- A. \$500,000
- B. \$750,000
- C. \$125,000
- D. \$31,250

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

9.

A health system CEO wants to combine the emergency-department staffing models of two hospitals it owns. Staff at both sites are comfortable with current schedules and see no reason to change. Both hospitals hold Magnet status. Using Kotter’s model, what should the CEO do first?

- A. Anchor the new model in the culture.
- B. Announce the new model and require full compliance next month.
- C. Form a guiding coalition of leaders from both sites.
- D. Create a sense of urgency by sharing the data on why change is needed.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

10.

The quality director at a 60-physician multispecialty group, which recently won a large employer contract, tracks the percentage of diabetic patients who had an HbA1c test in the past 12 months. The group just opened a new parking garage. Under Donabedian's model, this is a(n):

- A. Process measure
- B. Outcome measure
- C. Outcome measure, because every quality metric measures outcomes.
- D. Structure measure, because it relates to the new garage and facilities.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which of these is an outcome measure?

- A. Number of cardiologists on staff.
- B. Nurse-to-patient ratio on the cardiac unit.
- C. Percentage of heart-failure patients given discharge instructions.
- D. 30-day readmission rate for heart-failure patients.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

Planning a new behavioral health unit, a project manager maps stakeholders. The state certificate-of-need board has strong power over approval but little day-to-day interest in the project. The local paper recently covered the hospital's 50th anniversary. How should the project manager handle the board?

- A. Keep informed.
- B. Keep satisfied.
- C. Manage closely.
- D. Monitor with minimal effort.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A 120-bed rural hospital ~~that has served its county since 1962~~ is planning an outpatient orthopedic clinic. The planning team learns that a large retirement community is being built ten miles away. ~~The board chair is a retired surgeon.~~ In a SWOT analysis, the new retirement community is a(n):

Target word: SWOT quadrant **Decides:** An outside market trend that could help.

A	Dropped element	Uncontrollable outside factors are exactly what O and T capture.
B	Adjacent category	Strengths are internal capabilities; the community is outside the hospital.
C	Correct	It is external and favorable: a growing pool of likely orthopedic patients.
D	Inverted operation	It is external but favorable, not harmful.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

Which item belongs in the Weaknesses quadrant of a hospital's SWOT?

Target word: find the internal negative **Decides:** Weakness = internal and unfavorable.

A	Adjacent category	An outside policy change is a threat, not a weakness.
B	Inverted operation	Internal but favorable: a strength.
C	Confusion set	External and harmful: a threat.
D	Correct	An internal problem the hospital controls.

3. Answer B Concept 2

A nurse manager on a 28-bed medical unit wants to reduce patient falls. ~~The unit was repainted last spring.~~ She plans an hourly-rounding protocol, predicts falls will drop, and tries it on one hallway for two weeks. What is the next step in the PDSA cycle?

Target word: next PDSA step **Decides:** Plan and Do are complete.

A	Inverted operation	Restarts the cycle before learning from the test.
B	Correct	Study follows Do.
C	Dropped element	Skips Study; you don't yet know whether it worked.
D	Confusion set	Act comes after Study, not before.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A billing specialist at a 200-physician practice ~~with offices in two states~~ must fix a claim denied for a wrong procedure code. ~~The practice recently moved to a cloud-based electronic health record.~~ Under HIPAA, what access is appropriate?

Target word: scope of PHI access **Decides:** Payment task; minimum necessary applies.

A	Correct	Minimum necessary limits use to what the task requires; payment needs no authorization.
B	Absolute language	Being an employee does not grant access to everything.
C	Adjacent category	Payment activities are permitted without authorization.
D	Camouflage	The vendor does not decide workforce access.

5. Answer C Concept 4

A clinic plans a sleep-study service at \$600 per study. Variable cost is \$250 per study and fixed costs are \$210,000 a year. ~~A consultant noted that about 30% of adults snore. The clinic has three exam rooms.~~ How many studies a year are needed to break even?

Target word: break-even volume **Decides:** Contribution margin = \$600 – \$250 = \$350.

A	Inverted operation	\$210,000 / \$250 divides by variable cost instead of margin.
B	Camouflage	Applies the 30% snoring figure, which does not decide break-even.
C	Correct	\$210,000 / \$350 = 600 studies.
D	Dropped element	\$210,000 / \$600 ignores variable cost.

6. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

A service breaks even at 500 procedures a year. The price is \$400 and the variable cost is \$160 per procedure. What are the annual fixed costs?

Target word: solve for fixed costs **Decides:** Fixed costs = 500 × (\$400 – \$160).

A	Inverted operation	Adds variable cost to price instead of subtracting.
B	Correct	500 × \$240 = \$120,000.
C	Confusion set	500 × \$160 is total variable cost, not fixed cost.
D	Dropped element	500 × \$400 leaves out variable cost.

7. Answer C Concept 5

A health system spends \$900,000 on a new imaging scanner expected to bring in net cash inflows of \$300,000 a year for five years. ~~The vendor is based in Minnesota and was ranked first by a trade magazine.~~ What is the payback period?

Target word: payback in years **Decides:** \$900,000 / \$300,000 per year.

A	Wrong stem number	That is the useful life, not payback.
B	Adjacent category	Total inflows minus cost is net gain, not a time period.
C	Correct	\$900,000 / \$300,000 = 3.
D	Inverted operation	Divides inflow by investment.

8. Answer A Concept 5 • transfer

A project with a six-year useful life pays back in 4 years with equal annual inflows of \$125,000. What was the initial investment?

Target word: solve for investment **Decides:** Investment = payback × annual inflow.

A	Correct	4 × \$125,000 = \$500,000.
B	Wrong stem number	Uses the six-year life instead of the payback period.
C	Dropped element	One year of inflow, not the full investment.
D	Inverted operation	Divides inflow by payback instead of multiplying.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A health system CEO wants to combine the emergency-department staffing models of two hospitals it owns. Staff at both sites are comfortable with current schedules and see no reason to change. ~~Both hospitals hold Magnet status.~~ Using Kotter's model, what should the CEO do first?

Target word: first change step **Decides:** Staff see no need to change.

A	Inverted operation	That is the final step.
B	Absolute language	Mandating without urgency invites resistance.
C	Confusion set	That is step two, after urgency.
D	Correct	Kotter's first step; people must see why before they follow how.

10. Answer A Concept 7

The quality director at a 60-physician multispecialty group, ~~which recently won a large employer contract, tracks the percentage of diabetic patients who had an HbA1c test in the past 12 months. The group just opened a new parking garage.~~ Under Donabedian's model, this is a(n):

Target word: measure type **Decides:** It counts whether a care step was done.

A	Correct	It measures whether a recommended test was performed.
B	Adjacent category	An outcome would be the patients' HbA1c control, not whether the test was done.
C	Absolute language	Donabedian separates structure, process, and outcome.
D	Camouflage	The garage is structure, but the metric counts a care action.

11. Answer D Concept 7 • transfer

Which of these is an outcome measure?

Target word: find the outcome **Decides:** A change in patient health status.

A	Adjacent category	A resource count is structure.
B	Confusion set	Staffing is structure.
C	Inverted operation	Giving instructions is a process step.
D	Correct	Readmission reflects the result of care.

12. Answer B Concept 8

Planning a new behavioral health unit, a project manager maps stakeholders. The state certificate-of-need board has strong power over approval but little day-to-day interest in the project. ~~The local paper recently covered the hospital's 50th anniversary.~~ How should the project manager handle the board?

Target word: grid quadrant strategy **Decides:** High power, low interest.

A	Inverted operation	That is for low power and high interest.
B	Correct	High power-low interest stakeholders get enough attention to stay satisfied.
C	Adjacent category	That is for high power and high interest.
D	Dropped element	Ignores the board's high power.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	10	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	3	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	SWOT: internal vs. external	Strengths and weaknesses are internal to the organization; opportunities and threats come from the outside environment.	Calling a favorable outside trend a strength.	Whether the fact is inside the organization's walls or in its market.
2	PDSA cycle	Plan a small test, Do it, Study the results against the prediction, then Act (adopt, adapt, or abandon).	Jumping from a small test straight to a full rollout.	A pilot has just been run on one unit.
3	HIPAA minimum necessary	Staff use or disclose only the minimum protected health information needed for the task; treatment, payment, and operations do not need patient authorization.	Assuming employees may see the full record, or that every use needs written consent.	A staff role and a specific task that needs some PHI.
4	Service-line break-even	Break-even volume = fixed costs / (price – variable cost per unit).	Dividing fixed costs by price or by variable cost.	A price, a per-unit cost, and annual fixed costs.
5	Payback period	Payback (even cash flows) = initial investment / annual net cash inflow.	Confusing payback with useful life or total profit.	An up-front cost and a steady yearly inflow.
6	Leading change (Kotter)	Change starts by creating a sense of urgency, then building a guiding coalition, and only later anchoring it in culture.	Announcing the change and demanding compliance.	Staff see no need to change.
7	Donabedian quality measures	Structure = resources and setting; process = what is done for the patient; outcome = the result in the patient's health.	Calling a care-delivery rate an outcome.	"Percentage of patients who received..." vs. "rate of readmission / mortality."
8	Stakeholder power/interest grid	High power-high interest: manage closely; high power-low interest: keep satisfied; low power-high interest: keep informed; low-low: monitor.	Treating every powerful stakeholder as manage closely.	A stakeholder's power and interest are both described.

Course scope (public description): This course is the culminating experience and assessment of healthcare business administration. This course requires the student to integrate and synthesize managerial skills with healthcare knowledge, resulting in a high quality final project that demonstrates professional managerial proficiency.